MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BOXES, WIREBOUND, FOR CALIBER .30 AND CALIBER .50 AMMUNITION

1. SCOPE.

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers wirebound wooden boxes suitable for overseas shipment of small arms ammunition.

1.2 Classification.—Wirebound boxes shall be of the following types, as specified:

Type I - for caliber .30, M19A1 ammunition boxes
Type II - for caliber .50, M2A1 ammunition boxes

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

2.1 The following specifications, standards, drawings, and publications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

FF-N-101 Nails; Spikes; Staples; and Tacks

MILITARY

MIL-W-6110 Wood; Determination of Moisture Content of

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

DRAWINGS

ORDNANCE CORPS

F7553348 Development of Box (Wirebound, Caliber .50)
D6574405 Development of Box (Wirebound, Caliber .30)
D7553347 Box, Wirebound for Boxes, Ammunition, Caliber .50, M2A1
C5581378 Box, Wirebound for Boxes, Ammunition, Caliber .30

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(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications.--The following publications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, unless otherwise stated, form a part of this specification.

Interstate Commerce Commission Regulations

(The Interstate Commerce Commission regulations are now a part of the Code of Federal Regulations (1949 Edition - Revised 1950) available from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 General.-- The boxes shall be free of defects as specified herein to the extent of the acceptable quality levels.

3.2 Pilot lot.--A pilot lot is a portion of the first production of a component item, subassembly, or component submitted by a contractor as evidence of his ability to meet the requirements of his contract. It must be representative of the identical material, and manufactured with the same equipment, tooling and methods, which he intends to use in mass production. The manufacturer shall send a pilot inspection lot to such point as is stated in the contract. The size of the pilot lot shall be 100 unless otherwise specified. The manufacturer shall not proceed with production until report on the inspection sample is available and a release for production has been received. The acceptance pilot lot shall be considered a delivery under the contract (see 6.1).

3.3 Material.

3.3.1 Wood.--Wood used in wirebound crates shall be from either group I, II, III or IV as follows:

GROUP I

Cottonwood	Fir, Noble	Spruce
Cypress	Magnolia	

GROUP II

Douglas-fir	Hemlock (Western)	Larch (tarmarack)
		Pine, Southern

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GROUP III

Ash, black	Elm, white	Sycamore
Ash, pumpkin	Maple, soft	Tupole, water
Black gum	Sweetgum (red gum)	

GROUP IV

Ash, white	Elm, rock	Maple, hard
Beech	Hackberry	Oak
Birch	Hickory	Pecan

3.3.1.1 Worm holes.—Small worm holes less than 1/16 inch in diameter shall be permitted. Worm holes ranging in size from 1/16 inch to 1/2 inch across the largest dimension shall be permitted provided the holes are at least six inches apart.

3.3.1.2 All pieces shall be made of well-seasoned lumber having a moisture content not exceeding 18 percent of the oven dry weight for boards or 15 percent for veneer at the time of manufacture of the box (see 4.3.1).

3.4 Component parts.

3.4.1 Face boards.—Sides, top, bottom and ends of the box may be made of either sawed lumber or single-thickness veneer. Face boards shall be made from groups I, II, III or IV woods as listed in paragraph 3.1.1.

3.4.1.1 Number of pieces.—Top and bottom shall be made of not more than three pieces. Sides and ends shall be made of one piece.

3.4.1.2 No face board shall be less than 2 1/2 inches wide at any point.

3.4.1.3 The thickness of face boards shall be 7/32 inch for groups I, II, and III woods and 3/16 inch for group IV.

3.4.2 Cleats and battens.—Cleats and battens shall be made from groups II, III or IV woods as listed in paragraph 3.1.1. Each cleat and batten shall be a single piece of wood without any joint.

3.4.3 Hardware.

3.4.3.1 Nails.—Nails shall be in accordance with requirements of Federal Specification FF-N-101.

3.4.3.2 Binding wire.—Binding wire shall be low carbon annealed steel wire. Binding wire shall have such physical properties as to permit satisfactory manufacture of the loops without fracturing the wire and give satisfactory closures without fracturing the wire.

3.4.3.3 Staples.—Staples shall be made from low carbon annealed steel wire.

3.5 Construction.

3.5.1 Each binding wire shall be fastened by staples astride the wire which either shall pass through the face boards and be clinched or shall pass through the face boards and into the cleats as specified upon the applicable drawing. The points of the staples shall not protrude from the surface of the wood but if driven through a board or cleat, they shall be clinched.

3.6 Workmanship.- Status of workmanship shall be such that the material will meet the requirements of 3.1 through 3.5.1. The material shall meet the inspection requirements for defects in quality and dimensions as specified in 4.2.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Sampling.—Sampling shall be in accordance with inspection level II, table III of Standard MIL-STD-105.

4.1.1 Production lot.—The lot size shall be as specified by the Contracting Officer but shall not be greater than 25,000 boxes. The first lot manufactured on any contract, except when a new contract immediately follows the manufacture of satisfactory material of the same kind, shall consist of 2,000 plus or minus 500 boxes.

4.1.2 Surveillance lot.—The Contracting Officer shall send sample inspection lots for quality evaluation to such point as is stated in contract. The sample lot shall consist of six unassembled boxes from each month's production. Upon receipt of report of inspection, the inspector shall inform the Contracting Officer of any unacceptable quality and the box manufacturer shall immediately make corrections. The acceptable surveillance lots shall be considered deliveries under the contract.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 Dimensional.—Suitable measuring instruments, such as micrometer calipers, a graduated scale or rule, etc., shall be used in determining the dimensions of the finished crate.

4.2.2 Acceptable quality levels.—The acceptable quality levels with respect to visual and dimensional defects are as follows:

Defects	Percent
Major	1.0
Minor	4.0
Incidental	10.0

4.2.3 Classification of defects.

TABLE 1 - Defect Classification

No. in Insp. Manual	Defect	Major	Minor	Incidental
	Material			
	Knots:			
8	Tight knot larger than 1/3 width of board or 2 1/2" diameter, whichever is lesser		x	
9	Tight knot larger than 1/2 width of cleat or batten	x		
10	Loose knot or knot hole larger than 1" diameter in board		x	
10a	Loose knot or knot hole in cleat or batten	x		
12	* Decay	x		
12a	Bark edge			x
	Cross grain:			
13	In face boards having slope greater than 1 in 6 (except grain structure surrounding knots)			x
13a	In cleats and battens having slope greater than 1 in 8 (except grain structure surrounding knots)		x	

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TABLE 1 - Defect Classification (continued)

No. in Insp. Manual	Defect	Major	Minor	Incidental
	Splits:			
14a	Forming a sliver at the outside edge of board			x
14b	Forming a cross break at the outside edge of board		x	
15	Full length - more than one per narrow piece (4" wide or less)		x	
16	Full length - more than two in a part		x	
17	Partial - over 1/3 length but less than full length - more than three in a part		x	
18	Full length in cleat or batten	x		
19	Shake or soft spots		x	
	Broken board:			
20a	Broken or split off for full length or width of piece	x		
20b	Broken or split off more than 1/3 length or width of piece but less than full length or width		x	
	Wire:			
21	Untreated binding or stapling		x	
23	Prong of loop fastener not driven through board and clinched	x		
26	Any broken, missing or unsatisfactorily spliced	x		
27	Loose at corner of box		x	
27a	Short loop preventing closing of box	x		
	WORKMANSHIP & ASSEMBLY			
	Stapling or nailing:			
28	Protruding point	x		
29	More than two binding wire staples missing, broken or poorly driven (one leg of staple not driven into board) per wire		x	
30	More than one batten staple missing or head protruding (per batten)		x	
32	More than one batten nail missing or head protruding (per batten)		x	

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TABLE 1 - Defect Classification (continued)

No. in Insp. Manual	Defect	Major	Minor	Incidental
	Wood parts:			
35	Missing cleat or batten	x		
41	Overlapping boards			x
-	Manufacturer's identification placed on outside of crate	x		
-	**Inside height, length or width under minimum	x		
-	**Inside height, length or width over maximum		x	
-	Wood species not according to specification			x
-	Outer surface of boards too rough for legible marking		x	

NOTE: For illustration of visual defects refer to ORD-SIP-S321 "Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition Packing and Wirebound Crates".

* In case of dispute over decay, it shall be submitted to a Government laboratory for determination as to whether decay exists.

** In case sample does not meet requirements for minimum or maximum dimensions, a work test shall be the deciding factor.

NOTE: A box containing one or more major defects or one or more minor defects shall be counted as a single major or minor defect respectively. A box containing one or more major defects together with one or more minor defects shall be counted both as a major and a minor. A box containing a single defect which is major and minor shall be counted as a major only.

4.3 Test method.

4.3.1 Moisture content.--The moisture content of the wood shall be determined in accordance with MIL-W-6110.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY.

5.1 Packaging and packing.--Wirebound boxes shall be shipped knocked down to occupy a minimum amount of space and where practicable shall be tied in bundles of not more than ten. The ends shall be tied in bundles of not more than 40.

5.2 Marking.--Manufacturer's identification, year of manufacture and specification number shall be stamped on an inside surface of the top, bottom or side of the box.

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6. NOTES.

6.1 Ordering data.--Procurement documents should specify the following:

Title, number and date of this specification.

Patent Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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